

CATALYST BY THIRIVEMBA • NATIONAL CASE COMPETITION

TRACK I • PRODMAN OF THE YEAR



CASE SUBMISSION

Closing the Execution Gap

"Building the V that becomes every Indian MBA student's daily habit"

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STARTUPS

THE EXECUTION GAP



MBA ASPIRANTS

India's startup ecosystem is growing at an unprecedented pace.



2.23 Lakh

DIIT - recognized startups



23 lakh

Direct jobs created



55,000

Startups added in FY 2025-26



The ecosystem continues to expand rapidly with more than 55,000 startups recognized in FY 2025 – 26 alone

THE MARKET FAILURE

India has thousands of startups that need support in:

1. Market research
2. Competitor analysis
3. Customer acquisition
4. Sales outreach
5. GTM planning
6. Growth experimentation



No platform systematically connects them.

Simultaneously, MBA students struggle to find meaningful opportunities that create measurable proof of work.

1. They lack:
2. Real execution
3. Proof of work
4. Startup exposure
5. Industry credibility



Two sides need each other. No platform systematically connects them.



THE INSIGHT

The employability problem is not a learning problem. It is an execution visibility problem.

TIER 1 MBA STUDENTS

1. Students from top institutions benefit from:
2. Alumni-led opportunities
3. Industry-sponsored projects
4. Recruiter visibility
5. Brand-backed credibility



CREDIBILITY GAP

Performance
Reputation

TIER 2 & TIER 3 MBA STUDENTS

For the majority of MBA students, the experience is fundamentally different.

They graduate with:

1. Degrees
2. Certifications
3. Case competition participation
4. Academic projects

But often lack:

1. Real startup exposure
2. Industry-validated work
3. Proof of business execution
4. Recruiter visibility

On paper, this should be a perfect match
But the reality is very different

The result is a credibility gap.

Recruiters are no longer evaluating students only on what they know.

They increasingly evaluate students on what they have built, solved, executed, and delivered.

Thrive MBA

Career Execution Operating System for MBA Students

A platform where students solve real startup missions, build verified proof-of-work, earn reputation through performance, and graduate with a portfolio that demonstrates capability before placement season begins.



Two sides need each other. No platform systematically connects them.



THE INSIGHT

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Real Startup
Missions



Performance
reputation



Verified Proof
-of-Work



Placement
readiness



Mission

Transform every MBA student from a learner into a verified business problem solver

THRIVEMBA – BUILDING INDIA’S FIRST MBA EXECUTION NETWORK

From Learning Credential → To Verifiable Career Proof

1. THE MARKET OPPORTUNITY

India’s startup ecosystem is exploding. Execution exposure is not.

India Startup Ecosystem Growth & MBA Talent Supply

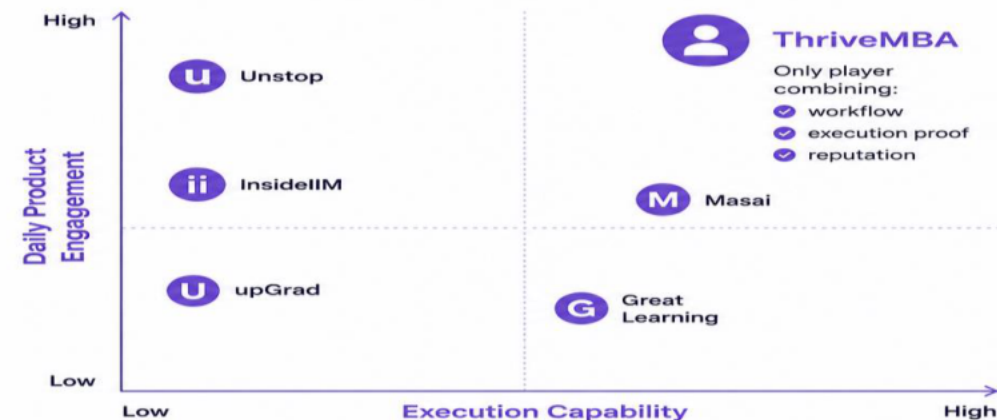


INSIGHT

1. India has built startup supply.
2. It has not built talent execution infrastructure.
3. The employability gap is no longer about knowledge. It is about proof of execution.

2. COMPETITOR POSITIONING

No player combines execution, workflow and reputation.



UNIT ECONOMICS SNAPSHOT (Illustrative)

Scalable, sustainable and impact-aligned.

Metric	Value (INR)	Notes
Avg Revenue / Student / Year	6,000	Subscription + Premium
Gross Margin	72%	High due to digital leverage
CAC (Blended)	1,250	SEO, Referrals, Campus
LTV (Student)	26,000	Subscription + Premium
LTV / CAC Ratio	22x	Strong unit economics
Contribution Margin	Positive	Post validation

Thrive MBA

India already built the startup economy. **ThriveMBA builds the execution infrastructure beneath it**



Real Startup work



Verified Proof



Recruiter Trust



Placement
Readiness

The future of employability will not belong to students who know more. It will belong to students who can prove more.”